

Spelling list

Baseline Dictionaries:

- British English: Oxford English Dictionary (using -ise endings) or Collins
- American English: Merriam-Webster (MW) or Oxford American
- Canadian English: Oxford Canadian Dictionary
- Australian English: Macquarie Dictionary or Australian Oxford Dictionary

SPELLINGS OVERRIDDEN IN ALL ENGLISH DIALECTS

Miscellaneous

Accents: Optional but permissive in loanwords like "café" and "cafe" while "naïve" and "naive". Always required in names or names of ethnic groups, ie Métis, Brontë or José. Do not put accents if a word is always accepted without accents even do traditionalists, like "elite" or "hotel".

Hyphens: Hyphenate BEFORE the noun, not after the noun: the **actor** is well known, a well-known **actor**.

Numbers: Spell out 1-10. Never start a sentence with a number. Advisable to use phrases like "a total number of..." to avoid violating this rule.

#

4chan

8chan

A

adviser (not advisor)

aesthetic (note: use ae)

African American (not African-American)

AI

aircraft or plane (not airplane)

all right

alumni (most common), alum (gender-neutral)

among (not amongst)

antisemitism

archaeology (note: use ae)

artifact

audiobook

Australian Labor Party

B

benefited, benefiting

bestseller

biannual, biennial, bimonthly, biweekly

BlackBerries

bumblebee

bumf (not bump)

C

caffeine, cafeteria (never put an accent even if café takes one)

cancellation (note: cancelled/cancelling remains a regional split)

château

co-author

Coca-Cola

co-ed (co-educational)

combated

co-op, multiplayer

cooperate

coordinate

counter-attack

co-worker, co-working

D

daycare

de-escalate

diarrhoea (British and Australian), diarrhea (American and Canadian)

doughnut

E

earned

ebook

e-commerce

email

emoji (plural emojis)

encyclopedia

ensure (make certain that will occur), insure (arrange for compensation)

e-sports

F

fetal

fetus

focused

formulas (used for tech / general contexts)

formulae (used for maths / chemistry contexts)

Frédéric Chopin

fundraising

G

ghettos

gram (never gramme)

grey

greyhound

groundbreaking

H

Haemorrhage (British and Australian), hemorrhage (American and Canadian)

healthcare

historical novel, historic, a (not "an" historical novel / "an" historic)

homemade

homeopathy

honorific

I

Indigenous Peoples

internet, the

Inuk (singular of Inuit)

iPhone

iTunes

J

jail

judgment, legal (universal)

K

keffiyeh

Kyiv

L

Labour Day (Hong Kong), Labour Party (UK)

learned (not "learnt")

LGBT+, LGBTQ+, LGBTQIA+, 2SLGBTQIA+

lifestyle

liquefy

livestream(ing)

lovable

lowlife

M

man-made (preferred alternatives: artificial or synthetic)

Māori (plural remains: the Māori)

medieval

microorganism

midday

midseason

midsummer

minuscule
mottoes
movable
multicultural
multi-ethnic
Muslim (not Moslem)
must-have

N
nationwide
nevertheless
newsfeed
nonetheless
non-binary
nondescript
non-existent
non-profit
no one

O
offline
online
onomatopoeia (note: use oe)
outnumber
outperform
out-thinking

P
paralleled
parallelism
passer-by (plural passers-by)
percent, percentage
phony

postgraduate, undergraduate

pre-eclampsia

pre-eminent

pre-empt

pre-existing

prerequisite

Pride (capitalised) but gay pride

program, computer

psychology

Q

queuing (preferred alternative: lining up)

Qur'an

R

rarefy

reallocate

re-elect

re-examine

rhythm

routing

S

skeptic

smartphone

soundtrack

spamming

startup culture

sulfur

supersede

T

textbook

tikka

TikTok

thesis (plural theses, also hypothesis, hypotheses)

today

tomorrow

U

UK, US (full stops redundant)

uncooperative

UNESCO (not Unesco)

V

vapour (British / Commonwealth), vapor (AmE), vaporous (never vapourous, which is a misspelling like humour/humorous pairs in British English), vaporise / vaporize (no u, but ise and ize depend on your dictionary, vaporise British Australian, vaporize Canadian American)

veranda

vice-principal

vice versa

voicemail

W

website, webpage

while (not whilst)

Wi-Fi

World Health Organization

worldwide

worthwhile

X

X-ray

Y

yogurt

z

zeros

zigzag